



Marlin Moodley Digital Insurance Platform

“One conversation. **Every policy. Every channel.**”

From emailing insurers and waiting for quotes, to operating an intelligent, compliant, AI-enabled insurance advisory and quotation platform across web, app and WhatsApp.

PREPARED FOR

Marlin Moodley — Senior Executive Financial Advisor

In partnership with Masthead Financial Planning (Pty) Ltd, FSP 43435

PREPARED BY

Move Digital

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What's inside

A complete strategy: where Marlin Moodley is today, the market opening, the platform and AI architecture we recommend, the compliance framework it must live inside, and a costed, phased implementation plan.

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The strategic story in one paragraph

Marlin Moodley today is a trusted, advice-led practice that serves clients over email and phone, and requests quotes from insurers manually. The opportunity is not “a website, an app and a chatbot.” It is to build a **digital insurance intermediary platform** — a quotation-orchestration and AI layer beneath a single customer experience — so a client can start one conversation on any channel and the platform gathers their needs, obtains comparable quotes from multiple insurers (in real time where APIs exist, through automated workflow where they don't), and hands the advisor a complete, compliant file to advise on. Advice stays human. Everything around it becomes instant.

01 Executive summary

South Africa is the most insured market in Africa, yet the life and disability cover gap has widened to R50.4 trillion. Customers now expect to transact in a conversation. A well-run advisory practice that digitises now can serve ten times the clients with the same advice quality.

R50.4trn

SA life & disability insurance gap at end-2024 — up 12.5% p.a. since 2021 (ASISA, Oct 2025)

±29m

South Africans on WhatsApp — the country's most-used platform (Statista/GeoPoll 2025)

R154bn

FY2024 non-life insurance revenue, up 9.8% (KPMG SA Insurance Survey 2025)

<7 min

Time for ILife's June 2026 WhatsApp journey to quote, customise and activate funeral cover

What we propose

The **Marlin Moodley Digital Insurance Platform — Launch Edition**: one build that puts the quote journey live on all three channels in 12 weeks. Web and app ship as a single installable PWA; WhatsApp delivers the same journey through the Business API; a launch panel of the practice's contracted insurers supplies car/household and life quotes — real-time where supported, an automated tracked workflow elsewhere; a custom-built CRM — owned, licence-free, on one data model — is the advisor workspace. Regulated advice and material decisions remain with the advisor. The fuller platform — native app, AI agent suite, Customer 360, predictive analytics — is **Phase 2, scoped on real launch data**.

DECISION 1

Three-tier insurer connectivity

Integrate insurers at whatever level they support — real-time API, digital/batch, or automated email/portal workflow — so launch never waits for the slowest insurer. The customer sees one experience.

DECISION 2

Compliance by design

FAIS, POPIA, TCF and the incoming COFI framework are designed into journeys, data and AI guardrails from day one — turning regulation into a trust advantage rather than a retrofit.

DECISION 3

AI assists, humans advise

AI agents handle information, intake, comparison, documents and follow-up. Suitability advice, claims outcomes and any decision with significant customer effect stay human-owned and auditable.

Investment and timeline

Scope	Delivers	Investment	Timeline
Launch Edition (this proposal)	Quote journeys on web/PWA, app and WhatsApp across a launch panel of up to 5 short-term + 5 life insurers; custom CRM workspace with document vault; bought-lead ingestion and email automations; compliance & security baseline	R595k fixed	12 weeks
Hosting, support & maintenance	Cloud & licences, WhatsApp/AI usage, support and continuous improvement	R50k /month	from launch
Phase 2 — scale-up	Native app, AI agent suite, Customer 360 intelligence, predictive analytics, more insurers	Scoped on launch data	post-launch

02 Current-state assessment

A new practice with unusual clarity: broad insurer access already contracted, a compliance home at Masthead, and no legacy book to migrate. The digital estate, however, is a brochure — not a platform — and the growth engine the practice plans (bought leads at volume) has nothing to land on yet.

STRENGTHS

- **Advice-led trust:** advising since 2004; positioning as “Senior Executive Financial Advisor”.
- **Insurer access already contracted:** life agency codes with Momentum, Discovery, Old Mutual, BrightRock, Bidvest Life, PPS, Sanlam and Liberty; short-term with Momentum, Discovery, Old Mutual, Santam, Hollard, CIA, iTOO, One, Elite, Echelon and Brolink.
- **Regulatory home:** operates in partnership with Masthead Financial Planning (Pty) Ltd, FSP 43435, with a practice manager in place — an established compliance umbrella.
- **Clean slate:** a new practice with no legacy book — zero data migration — and existing FICA/onboarding documentation to build on.

CONSTRAINTS

- **Email-based servicing:** every quote is requested manually from multiple insurers and waited on; no orchestration, tracking or SLA visibility.
- **No WhatsApp API channel:** the business number is on WhatsApp, but without a verified Meta Business Manager there are no journeys, automation or compliance records — only a consumer app.
- **No client portal or self-service:** no policy view, document vault, claims intake or renewals journey.
- **Interim CRM only:** Iris (Masthead’s white-labelled system, with an Astute email link) holds client management today — serviceable, but not a platform the practice owns or can extend to its own products.
- **Capacity ceiling:** growth is currently bounded by the advisor’s and assistants’ inboxes and calendars — untenable at the planned ±50 quotes/week from bought leads.

Website audit — issues to fix regardless of the platform build

Finding	Detail	Severity
Broken contact email	Contact page shows “info@marlinmoodley” with no domain suffix; no tappable <i>mailto:</i> or <i>tel:</i> links anywhere on the site.	High — losing leads
Compliance presentation	No privacy/POPIA notice, complaints process, conflict-of-interest disclosure or advisor representative details visible; only the umbrella FSP number is cited.	High — regulatory
Trust signals missing	“Address” heading on the contact page has no address beneath it; no map, no LinkedIn, no reviews surfaced.	Medium
Unclear hero message	Homepage headline is jargon-heavy and doesn’t state who the practice serves or what to do next.	Medium
Template residue & plugin bloat	Stock template artefacts, factory-default styles, comment forms exposed on the booking page, six overlapping plugins slowing every load.	Low–Medium

Quick wins (immediate, minimal cost): fix the email address and make phone/email tappable; add a WhatsApp click-to-chat link; publish POPIA privacy notice, complaints and disclosure pages; rewrite the hero headline around client outcomes; remove template residue. These repair the leaks while the platform is built.

The operating problem in one picture

Today: enquiry → email trail → advisor manually emails 3–6 insurers → days of waiting and re-keying → hand-built comparison → advice → paper-heavy onboarding.

Tomorrow: conversation on any channel → digital needs analysis → platform requests quotes from every connected insurer at once → comparable results in minutes (Tier A) or tracked hours (Tier B/C) → advisor advises from a complete file → digital onboarding, servicing and renewals.

03 Market opportunity

Three forces are converging: a widening protection gap, customers living in conversational channels, and an insurance stack that is finally opening its APIs. Intermediaries who orchestrate all three win.

11.5%

Insurance penetration as % of GDP — Africa's highest, vs ±6.8% globally

R3.1m

Average underinsurance per income earner across SA's 16.1m earners (ASISA 2025)

39%

Share of household income needs actually covered; critical-illness cover ratio just 26%

R5trn+

SA life insurers' assets — first time above R5 trillion (ASISA)

Why now — three market signals

SIGNAL 1 · CHANNELS

Insurance is moving into WhatsApp

1Life launched an end-to-end WhatsApp funeral-cover journey in June 2026 — quote to active policy in under 7 minutes. MTN sells Sanlam-underwritten funeral cover entirely via WhatsApp; Sanlam runs WhatsApp self-service. The conversational bar is now set for every product line.

SIGNAL 2 · RAILS

APIs are opening

Nedbank publishes a Short-Term Insurance API with sandbox access. Root exposes 500+ insurance APIs; Genasys 450+ endpoints; Brolink's Websure offers comparative multi-quote into live policy issue. Real-time intermediation is technically feasible today.

SIGNAL 3 · CAPITAL

Digital models are validated

Naked raised \$17m (IFC-led, 2023); Pineapple raised R400m (2023) — then Africa's largest insurtech round. Investors and insurers have proven that digital distribution works in SA; advice-led intermediaries are the under-served spot.

The intermediary's advantage

Direct insurtechs sell one balance sheet. Aggregators sell leads. An FSP-backed advisory platform can do what neither can: **compare across insurers and advise** — with a licensed human accountable for suitability. The ASISA gap study shows the market's problem is not appetite but access and advice capacity. A platform that lets one advisor run hundreds of concurrent, compliant conversations attacks exactly that constraint.

Opportunity framing

Capturing even a microscopic share of a R50.4-trillion cover gap is a life-changing book of business for a boutique practice. The goal of digitisation is not cost-cutting — it is **advice capacity**: more needs analyses started, more quotes compared, more policies placed and retained per advisor-hour, at documented TCF quality.

Sources: ASISA Life & Disability Insurance Gap Study 2025 (Oct 2025); KPMG South African Insurance Industry Survey 2025; Statista / Finance in Africa 2025; GeoPoll 2025; FAnews (1Life, Jun 2026); TechCentral (MTN Khava; Pineapple, Nov 2023); TechCrunch (Naked, Feb 2023); Nedbank API Marketplace; rootplatform.com; genasys.tech.com; brolink.co.za.

04 Strategic vision & platform concept

One platform, four layers. Customers meet a single brand experience on the channel they prefer; underneath, a shared core and an AI layer orchestrate insurers, documents, workflow and compliance.

CUSTOMER CHANNELS — ONE EXPERIENCE EVERYWHERE

Website / PWA

WhatsApp Business Platform

Mobile app (Phase 2)

Voice (future)

Human advisor — in the loop on every channel

AI LAYER — ASSISTIVE INTELLIGENCE, GUARD-RAILED

AI Insurance Concierge

Quote & Application Agent

Document Intelligence

Advisor Copilot

Renewal & Retention Intelligence

FNOL / Claims Intake

Next-Best-Action

Knowledge & Policy Assistant

CORE PLATFORM

Customer 360

Identity & consent

Digital needs analysis

Quote orchestration engine

Policy & servicing

Document management

Workflow & case management

CRM / advisor workspace

Analytics & reporting

INSURER CONNECTIVITY — THREE TIERS (SECTION 08)

Tier A · Real-time APIs

Tier B · Digital / batch

Tier C · Automated email & portal workflow

CROSS-CUTTING

FAIS / TCF compliance engine

POPIA consent & privacy

Audit trail on every interaction

Security & DevSecOps

Design principles

1 · Conversation-first, channel-agnostic

Journeys are designed once as conversational flows, rendered on web, WhatsApp and app. A client can start on WhatsApp and finish with the advisor without repeating themselves.

2 · Orchestrate, don't wait

Never block on the slowest insurer: Tier A quotes return live; Tier B/C run as tracked cases with SLAs, automated chasers and visible status.

3 · Advice stays human

AI prepares; the licensed advisor advises. Every client-facing AI output is explainable, logged and escalation-ready — the FAIS-safe posture and the brand promise.

4 · Data compounds

Every interaction enriches Customer 360 — powering renewals, cross-sell, retention and prediction. The data asset is the long-term moat.

05 Target customers & segmentation

Digitisation lets the practice serve segments that were previously uneconomic to reach — without diluting the high-touch service that anchors the brand.

Segment	Profile & need	Primary products	Lead channel
Established professionals	35–55, families, peak earning years; ASISA shows even earners with cover hold only ~39% of what households need. Time-poor, expect digital convenience with human advice.	Life, disability, income protection, critical illness, investments, estate planning	Web + advisor; WhatsApp servicing
Young professionals	25–35, first policies; digital-native, comparison-driven, small initial premiums but decades of lifetime value.	Income protection, life starter cover, retirement annuities	WhatsApp + web self-serve
SMME owners	Business + personal lines together: key-person cover, buy-and-sell, business assets, group benefits. Underserved by direct players; value one accountable advisor.	Business assurance, commercial short-term, group risk, health	Web + advisor; referrals
Households (short-term)	Car, household and building cover; the site already receives these requests with no product page behind them. High-frequency quote shoppers — ideal for real-time comparison.	Motor, household contents, buildings	WhatsApp + web instant quote
Existing client base	Retention and share-of-wallet: annual reviews, renewals, beneficiaries, claims support. Cheapest growth available.	Reviews, top-ups, cross-sell, wills & trusts	WhatsApp servicing + Copilot-driven outreach

Segment strategy

- **Lead with short-term instant quotes** to prove the real-time promise and generate volume; **monetise depth** through advice-led life, investment and estate work where the practice's credibility is strongest.
- **Protect the premium tier:** established professionals and SMMEs get advisor-first journeys with digital convenience — never a purely automated sale.
- **Grow the base digitally:** young professionals and quote-shoppers enter through low-friction channels and graduate into advised relationships as needs mature — the Next-Best-Action engine manages that progression.

06 Go-to-market strategy

Launch on trust, scale on convenience. The GTM sequence mirrors the build: fix the funnel, open WhatsApp, prove instant quotes, then amplify.

GTM WAVE 1

Foundation

Weeks 1–4

Repair & relaunch the web funnel: outcome-led messaging, working contact paths, compliance pages, WhatsApp click-to-chat, Google Business Profile with reviews. Stand up the lead engine: bought-lead vendor feed into the CRM with automated follow-up — every lead landed, tracked and worked from day one.

GTM WAVE 2

Conversational launch

Weeks 6–12

WhatsApp channel live with needs-analysis and quote-request journeys; POPIA-compliant opt-in capture at every touchpoint. Local SEO + targeted social (the practice already runs Facebook/Instagram) driving to WhatsApp. Referral mechanic: one-tap “share my advisor” card.

GTM WAVE 3

Instant-quote proof

Months 4–6

“Compare real quotes in minutes” campaign on short-term lines once Tier A/B integrations are live — the demonstrable differentiator vs. every traditional brokerage. Content engine: AI-assisted, advisor-approved explainers on the protection gap, one per week, distributed via social + WhatsApp broadcast (opt-in).

GTM WAVE 4

Scale & partnerships

Months 6–12

App adoption push — every active client invited to install the PWA. B2B2C partnerships: accountants, attorneys, estate agents and employers embedding Marlin Moodley journeys (the platform’s API-first design makes each partnership a configuration, not a build). Explore employer group-scheme offerings for SMME clients.

Positioning & message house

Brand promise

“One conversation. Every policy. Every channel.” — expert advice with marketplace convenience.

vs. direct insurtechs

“They sell you one insurer’s product. We compare the market — and a licensed advisor is accountable for the advice.”

vs. traditional brokers

“Same trusted advice — but quotes in minutes, service on WhatsApp, and your entire portfolio in one view.”

Budget guidance: media and content budgets are detailed in the accompanying commercial presentation. Until Wave 2 begins, the funnel-repair and referral motions are near-zero-cost and typically outperform paid media for advisory practices.

07 Channel strategy – web, WhatsApp, app

Sequence matters: web/PWA rebuilds credibility and captures search demand; WhatsApp meets clients where they already are; the native app rewards the established base. All three share the same journeys and core.

Website / PWA – the credibility and conversion engine (Weeks 3–9)

Experience

- Outcome-led product pages for every line (incl. the missing short-term pages), calculators (life-cover gap, income-protection), and educational content targeting protection-gap search terms.
- Digital needs-analysis wizard → instant Tier A quotes or tracked quote case; secure client portal: policies, documents, claims status, renewals, secure messaging.
- PWA: installable, offline-tolerant, push-capable — 80% of app value at 20% of app cost, available from day one.

Foundation

- Full FAIS/POPIA disclosure set, cookie/consent management, complaints journey, advisor credentials.
- Analytics with funnel tracking from first visit to policy issue; A/B testing on needs-analysis entry points.
- Local SEO (practice location, reviews) + structured data for financial services.

WhatsApp – the servicing and reach channel (Weeks 5–9)

Journeys

- **Enquire & quote:** guided needs capture, document upload (ID, licence, existing schedules), quote status, appointment booking.
- **Service:** policy documents, beneficiary updates, claims intake (FNOL), premium queries, renewal confirmations.
- **Advisor handover** at any moment — the advisor sees full conversation context in the workspace.

Economics & compliance

- Meta's July 2025 per-message pricing makes **customer-initiated service conversations effectively free**, with modest per-template fees for utility and marketing messages. A service-led strategy is structurally cheap to run.
- POPIA s69: broadcast/marketing only to opted-in contacts, opt-out honoured in-channel; full conversation archival for FAIS record-keeping.

Mobile app – the loyalty channel (Phase 2)

Native app (single codebase, iOS + Android) once the base justifies it: biometric login, portfolio dashboard across all policies and investments, document vault, claims tracking, renewal nudges, secure chat. Success metric is engagement of existing clients — not downloads. The PWA carries acquisition until then, and the app reuses its journeys and APIs, which is why it lands in Phase 2 rather than the launch build.

Future voice channel: the conversational architecture (intent → journey → core APIs) is voice-ready by design; a phone/IVR AI concierge can be added later without re-platforming.

08 Real-time quotes & insurer connectivity

The single most important architectural decision: integrate every insurer at the level they can support today, behind one orchestration engine — so the customer experience never depends on the slowest counterparty.

The three-tier connectivity model

Tier	Insurer capability	Customer & advisor experience	How it works
A	Real-time quote API	Instant quotes — comparable premiums in minutes, side by side	Direct API integration via the orchestration engine; quote → accept → bind where supported
B	Digital / batch integration (platform, file exchange, structured portal)	Near-real-time — “your quotes are being prepared; expect them within X hours,” tracked live	Platform-mediated requests with automated status polling and normalisation into the same comparison view
C	Email / manual portal only	Automated workflow — structured request generated and sent automatically; case tracked with SLAs and chasers; human handles exceptions only	Templated submissions from the needs analysis; inbound replies parsed by Document Intelligence into the comparison view

Every tier lands in the **same normalised quote object** — so comparison, advice records and analytics work identically however the quote arrived; as insurers modernise they simply move up a tier with no customer-facing change.

The SA connectivity landscape (verified, August 2026)

Counterparty	Likely tier	What's available
Nedbank Insurance	A	Published Short-Term Insurance API (motor & building) — OAuth 2.0, sandbox for testing
Root Platform	A	500+ insurance APIs — quote, policy issue, collections, claims; embedded/white-label distribution
Genasys	A	450+ REST endpoints, no-code product builder; powers King Price, GuardRisk, GENRIC, bSpoke
Brolink (Websure)	A — B	Comparative multi-quote straight into policy administration; Astute Short-Term Switch connectivity; integration APIs
OWLS · Cardinal C360i · SSP	B	API-driven broker/UMA admin platforms — candidate backbones with connectivity built in
Santam · Old Mutual Insure · Hollard · Discovery	C → B	Broker portals today (Santam App Store quick-quote, MyOMInsure); automated workflow now, upgrade path as APIs open
Life & investment houses	C	Adviser-portal driven; tracked cases with document-intelligence parsing of returned quotes

Build-vs-buy recommendation: evaluate licensing an established broker-administration backbone (Brolink Websure, OWLS, Genasys, Cardinal) for policy admin + insurer connectivity, and build the differentiation — experience, AI layer, Customer 360 — on top. Materially cheaper and faster than integrating insurers one by one; a key Sprint 0 decision.

Sources: Nedbank API Marketplace (apim.nedbank.co.za); rootplatform.com; genasys.tech; brolink.co.za & FAnews Websure coverage; owlssoftware.com; cardinal.co.za; santam.co.za broker portal; Old Mutual Broker Corner.

09 AI strategy – agents, intelligence, analytics

AI is the force multiplier that lets one advisor run hundreds of concurrent, compliant client journeys. Every agent operates inside explicit FAIS/POPIA guardrails: AI prepares and predicts; the advisor advises and decides.

CUSTOMER-FACING

AI Insurance Concierge

24/7 first responder on web & WhatsApp: explains products factually, answers questions, collects needs-analysis information, books advisor appointments, hands over seamlessly. Never recommends products.

CUSTOMER-FACING

Quote & Application Agent

Turns a completed needs analysis into structured quote requests across all tiers; prepares applications; identifies missing information and chases it conversationally.

CUSTOMER-FACING

FNOL / Claims Intake

Guided claims first-notification on WhatsApp/web: captures incident details, documents and photos; creates the case; sets expectations. Claims decisions remain with insurer and advisor.

BACK-OFFICE

Document Intelligence

Reads IDs, bank confirmations, existing policy schedules and emailed insurer quotes (the Tier C unlock); extracts structured data with human verification on low-confidence fields.

ADVISOR-FACING

Advisor Copilot

Pre-meeting client briefs from Customer 360, side-by-side quote summaries with factual differences, drafted (advisor-approved) records of advice, and after-meeting action lists.

ADVISOR-FACING

Knowledge & Policy Assistant

Retrieval-based assistant over insurer product rules, policy wordings and regulatory guidance — answers cite their sources, so the advisor verifies in one click.

INTELLIGENCE

Renewal & Retention

Predicts lapse/churn risk from payment, engagement and life-event signals; triggers advisor-approved outreach before the client shops elsewhere. Renewals become campaigns, not surprises.

INTELLIGENCE

Next-Best-Action

Surfaces gap-based opportunities per client (e.g. cover ratio vs. ASISA benchmarks, life events, missing product lines) ranked by likelihood and value — feeding the advisor's day, not spamming the client.

INTELLIGENCE

Predictive analytics

Funnel conversion, quote-to-bind rates by insurer/segment, channel economics, workload forecasting — the management dashboard for running the practice as a platform.

Launch Edition scope: structured journeys with a tightly guard-railed assistant, plus Tier C document parsing. The full agent suite below — copilot, retention, next-best-action, predictive analytics — is the Phase 2 roadmap, enabled by the same architecture.

The guardrail model — designed for FAIS & POPIA

AI can

- Explain and educate factually; compare factual product attributes
- Collect information and prepare needs analyses & applications
- Summarise documents, meetings and portfolios; identify missing information
- Assist advisors, trigger workflows, draft for human approval

AI does not, independently

- Provide financial advice or product recommendations to clients
- Make suitability determinations or material underwriting judgements
- Decide claims outcomes
- Take any solely automated decision with significant customer consequences (POPIA s71)

Every AI interaction is logged with inputs, outputs and model version; algorithm performance is monitored and reviewed per FSCA Board Notice 194 of 2017 requirements for automated advice tooling (Section 11). Confidence thresholds route uncertain cases to humans by default.

10 Customer 360 & Advisor Copilot

The quiet engine of the whole strategy: one longitudinal record per client, and a workspace that turns it into advisor leverage.

Customer 360 — the single client record

What it holds

- Identity & KYC/FICA status; consent and communication preferences (POPIA-grade, per purpose)
- Household & financial profile from needs analyses; life events
- Every policy across every insurer — cover, premiums, renewal dates, beneficiaries
- Full interaction history across web, WhatsApp, app, email and meetings
- Documents: schedules, records of advice, claims files, wills & trusts

What it enables

- “Never repeat yourself” journeys across channels
- Cover-gap analysis per client against ASISA benchmarks — the advice conversation starter
- Renewal, retention and Next-Best-Action intelligence (Section 9)
- FAIS record-keeping and TCF evidence as a by-product of normal work, not an admin burden

Advisor workspace — a day in the life

08:00 — Copilot morning brief: 3 renewals at churn risk, 2 completed needs analyses awaiting advice, 5 quote cases (1 Tier C overdue — chaser already sent), today’s meetings with prepared client briefs.

10:00 — Client meeting: side-by-side quote comparison on screen; Copilot drafts the record of advice from the meeting; advisor edits, approves, signs — filed to Customer 360 automatically.

14:00 — WhatsApp handover: concierge escalates a complex estate-planning enquiry with full context; advisor answers in-thread; case created.

16:30 — Pipeline view: every open case by stage and SLA; management dashboard shows quote-to-bind by insurer and channel economics.

The workspace includes case/workflow management (every quote, claim and service request is a tracked case), a compliance cockpit (outstanding disclosures, advice records, consent status), and campaign tooling for advisor-approved outreach. The CRM is **custom-built on the platform’s own data model**: no per-seat licence fees, one schema shared by journeys, quotes and conversations (WhatsApp threads natively, no connector), and full POPIA data control. Its v1 scope is deliberately lean — pipeline, client record, case queue, inbox, documents, tasks — fixed with a written “not in v1” list during Sprint 0; Customer 360 intelligence is its natural Phase 2 evolution rather than an integration project.

11 Compliance by design – FAIS • POPIA • TCF • COFI

In financial services, compliance is not a constraint on the platform – it is the product’s trust layer. Every journey is designed against the regulatory frame below, validated with Masthead’s compliance function during Sprint 0.

Framework	What it requires	How the platform embeds it
FAIS Act (37 of 2002) + General Code of Conduct	“Advice” is defined broadly – any recommendation, guidance or proposal on a financial product. Factual information is excluded, but journeys that steer product choice can constitute advice, triggering suitability duties (GCoC s8) and record-keeping.	Hard separation between factual/educational content (AI-allowed) and advice (advisor-only); digital needs analysis captures client circumstances <i>before</i> advice; records of advice generated, approved and archived per interaction.
FSCA BN 194 of 2017 (automated advice)	Defines “automated advice” and requires FSPs using algorithms to monitor and review algorithm output, quality and suitability.	AI guardrail model (Section 9): no autonomous advice; algorithm logging, performance monitoring, human review cycles and documented sign-off built into the AI layer.
POPIA – s69, s71 + general conditions	Electronic direct marketing needs opt-in (or existing-customer exception with opt-out everywhere); no solely automated decisions with significant effect; lawful, minimal, secure processing.	Purpose-level consent registry; marketing sends gated on consent state; s71-sensitive decisions always human-in-the-loop with right to make representations; encryption, retention schedules, subject-access tooling.
TCF – six outcomes	Fair culture; products meet identified needs; clear information; suitable advice; products perform as expected; no unreasonable post-sale barriers.	TCF is instrumented, not filed: journey analytics evidence clear disclosure; needs-based product matching; claims/servicing SLAs; complaint journeys in every channel; management TCF dashboard.
Insurance Act 2017 + PPRs	Policyholder Protection Rules govern advertising, disclosure and intermediation in any medium – fully applicable to web/app/WhatsApp journeys.	Disclosure templates versioned per product/channel; advertising sign-off workflow; microinsurance/funeral standards applied where relevant.
COFI Bill (introduced 17 Apr 2026)	Will replace FAIS with an activity-based conduct framework under Twin Peaks.	Activity-based data model and audit trails position the platform for COFI transition without rework – an advantage over legacy intermediary systems.

Licensing structure – a Sprint 0 workstream, not an afterthought. The practice currently operates in partnership with Masthead Financial Planning (FSP 43435). The digital platform’s journeys, records and AI tooling must be agreed with the licence holder’s compliance function – or, if the ambition is an independent platform brand, obtaining an own FSP licence becomes part of the roadmap. Both paths are workable; the choice shapes branding, approval workflows and time-to-market, so we resolve it first. The IFWG Regulatory Sandbox is available if any journey (e.g. instant bind on WhatsApp) benefits from supervised live testing.

Sources: FAIS Act & General Code of Conduct; FSCA Board Notice 194 of 2017; POPIA ss 69, 71; FSCA TCF framework; Insurance Act 18 of 2017 & PPRs; Webber Wentzel / Moonstone on COFI introduction (Apr 2026); ifwg.co.za.

12 Security architecture

The platform will hold identity documents, financial profiles and health-adjacent information. Security is engineered to financial-services grade from the first sprint — it is also a POPIA condition, not just good practice.

Identity & access

- Customer identity with OTP + optional biometric (app); step-up authentication for sensitive actions
- Advisor/staff SSO with MFA; role-based least-privilege access; full admin audit trail
- WhatsApp number-verification bound to the client record before any personal data is shared in-channel

Data protection

- Encryption in transit (TLS 1.2+) and at rest; field-level encryption for ID numbers and financial data
- Data residency in-country or approved region per POPIA s72 transfer rules
- Purpose-bound retention schedules; secure deletion; documented operator agreements with every processor (cloud, AI, WhatsApp BSP)

Application & AI security

- OWASP-aligned secure SDLC; dependency and secret scanning in CI/CD; penetration test before each major launch
- AI-specific controls: prompt-injection defences, PII minimisation to model providers, output filtering, no client data used to train third-party models

Operations & resilience

- Centralised logging and alerting; incident-response runbook including POPIA breach notification duties
- Backups with tested restore; RPO/RTO targets defined in Sprint 0; DDoS and WAF protection at the edge
- Quarterly access reviews; annual security assessment aligned to the licence holder's requirements

Compliance artefacts delivered with the build

POPIA impact assessment

Information-security policy pack

Operator/processor agreements

Consent & retention register

Incident-response runbook

Pen-test report & remediation log

AI model & guardrail register

13 Technology architecture

Pragmatic and modular: buy the undifferentiated pieces, build the differentiating experience and orchestration, keep every integration behind an interface so components can be swapped as the market matures.

Layer	Recommended approach	Candidate technologies
Web / PWA	Modern reactive front-end, server-rendered for SEO, installable PWA	Next.js/React, TypeScript, Tailwind
Mobile app (Phase 2)	Single cross-platform codebase reusing platform APIs	React Native or Flutter
WhatsApp	WhatsApp Business Platform via an established BSP; conversation engine shared with web chat	Meta Cloud API + BSP (e.g. local SA BSP), conversation orchestration service
Core services	API-first modular services (identity, consent, needs analysis, quotes, cases, documents); event-driven where async (quote fan-out, chasers)	Node.js/TypeScript or .NET, PostgreSQL, REST + events/queues
Quote orchestration	Adapter per insurer/tier behind a normalised quote model; SLA timers & retry logic	Custom engine + admin-platform APIs (Brolink/OWLS/Genasys/Cardinal per Sprint 0 decision)
CRM / Customer 360	Custom-built advisor workspace on the platform's own data model — licence-free, single schema, native conversation threading	Same stack as core services; v1 scope fixed in Sprint 0
AI layer	LLM-agnostic gateway; retrieval (RAG) over curated product/regulatory content; guardrail and logging middleware; evaluation harness	Claude-class frontier LLM API, vector store, prompt/eval tooling
Data & analytics	Warehouse fed by platform events; dashboards for funnel, TCF and practice management; predictive models as they earn their keep	Cloud warehouse (BigQuery/Snowflake/Fabric), BI (Metabase/Power BI)
Cloud & DevSecOps	Managed cloud in POPIA-appropriate region; IaC; CI/CD with security gates; observability	AWS (af-south-1) or Azure (South Africa North), Terraform, GitHub Actions

Architecture principles: every insurer, CRM and AI provider sits behind an internal interface (swap without re-platforming); conversational journeys defined once, rendered per channel; all customer events flow to one stream (analytics, audit and AI context share a spine); nothing stateful in the channel layer — WhatsApp, web and app are thin clients over the same APIs.

14 Implementation roadmap – 12 weeks to live

One fixed-scope build, live in 12 weeks. The critical path is commercial, not code — Meta’s WhatsApp verification, insurer-panel onboarding and Masthead’s compliance sign-off all start on day one, in parallel with the build.

SPRINT 0

Compliance & setup

Weeks 1–2

Masthead journey sign-off pack; insurer launch-panel confirmation and WhatsApp BSP contracting; POPIA essentials (consent model, retention, privacy notices); architecture and fixed-scope build plan. **Started day one:** Meta business verification, insurer sandbox & onboarding requests, quick-win site fixes from Section 2.

BUILD

One journey, three channels

Weeks 3–9

Web/PWA quote experience (relaunched site, needs-analysis journey, installable PWA, case status); WhatsApp journeys with document upload and advisor handover; launch-panel insurer integrations (real-time where supported) + automated Tier C workflow; bought-lead feed into the CRM; custom CRM advisor workspace (parallel track on the shared backend), document vault, consent capture; security hardening throughout.

LAUNCH

Prove it live

Weeks 10–12

UAT with real clients on all three channels; penetration check and fixes; final compliance sign-off; lead-vendor feed switched to production, launch campaign, and go-live with tracked funnel analytics from day one.

PHASE 2

Scale-up

Post-launch

Scoped on real post-launch data: native app (or store wrapper), AI agent suite (copilot, document intelligence, retention, next-best-action), full Customer 360 intelligence, predictive analytics, additional insurer integrations. Everything in the Launch Edition — journeys, data model, vault, integrations — carries forward as its foundation.

Milestones

Stage	Milestones
Mobilise Weeks 1–2	Launch panel confirmed; WhatsApp BSP contracted; Meta verification submitted; Masthead pack agreed; POPIA essentials designed; site quick wins live; build plan frozen.
Build Weeks 3–6	Web/PWA journey in test; first live short-term quote returned end-to-end from an insurer sandbox; CRM pipeline configured; WhatsApp templates submitted for approval.
Harden Weeks 7–9	WhatsApp journeys live in test with document upload; Tier C automated workflow replacing manual email internally (immediate time savings); document vault and consent capture complete; hardening & pen check.
Go-live Weeks 10–12	Client UAT on all channels; compliance final sign-off; lead feed live; go-live . Funnel scorecard baselined for the Phase 2 decision.

What is never descoped: POPIA consent and retention, the advice/information boundary in every screen and message, FAIS record-keeping of conversations, and secure handling of identity documents. Cheap to build in, existential to skip.

15 Team requirements

A lean blended team, scaling with phases. Move Digital provides the delivery engine; Marlin Moodley provides domain authority and the compliance interface; specialist skills join when their phase needs them.

Role	Sprint 0	Build	Phase 2	Responsibility
Engagement / delivery lead	0.5	0.5–1	0.5	Plan, budget, stakeholders, compliance liaison
Solution architect	0.5	0.5	0.25	Architecture, build-vs-buy, integration design
Product designer (UX/UI)	0.5	1	0.5	Journeys, design system, conversational UX
Full-stack engineers	—	2–3	2–3	Web/PWA, core services, portal, app (Ph 3)
Integration engineer	—	1	0.5–1	Insurer adapters, CRM, WhatsApp BSP
AI engineer	—	1	1	Agents, RAG, guardrails, evaluation
QA / test automation	—	0.5–1	0.5	Functional, journey and regression testing
DevSecOps	—	0.5	0.25	Cloud, CI/CD, security tooling, observability
Data engineer / analyst	—	0.5	0.5–1	Warehouse, dashboards, predictive models (Ph 3)
Compliance advisor (specialist)	0.25	0.25	0.1	FAIS/POPIA/TCF review, Masthead alignment

Figures are indicative FTE allocations. Peak team ≈ 4–6 during the build; steady-state run team ≈ 1–2 (Section 16).

Client-side commitments that make it work

- **Domain authority:** ±4–6 advisor hours/week during design phases for journey reviews, product rules and advice-record standards — this is what makes the AI layer genuinely expert.
- **Compliance interface:** a named contact within Masthead's compliance function, engaged from day one.
- **Content & brand sign-off:** weekly cadence during launch waves; all client-facing AI content is advisor-approved at template level.

16 Investment – build & run costs

A total build investment of **R595,000 — fixed**, delivered in 12 weeks, with a flat **R50k per month** for hosting, support and maintenance from launch. Four scope decisions make the number possible; the figures match Quotation № MM-2026-01 and are fixed on acceptance.

The four scope decisions

1 · The PWA is the app

One installable Progressive Web App — home-screen icon, push, offline tolerance — delivers “web” and “app” from one codebase. An app-store wrapper is available as a priced option; the native app proper is Phase 2.

2 · One journey, rendered twice

Needs capture → quote → follow-up is designed once as a conversational flow, delivered on web/PWA and on WhatsApp via the Business API. No per-channel builds — the trick that keeps three channels in one budget.

3 · Integrate the contracted panel

A launch panel of up to **5 short-term + 5 life insurers**, drawn from the practice’s existing agency codes and integrated at whatever tier each supports; every other insurer rides the automated Tier C email workflow. Further integrations are priced add-ons, never blockers.

4 · Own the back office

A custom-built CRM is the advisor workspace — pipeline, client record, case queue, WhatsApp inbox threaded per client, encrypted document vault. No licence fees, one data model, and reusable IP; the AI suite and Customer 360 intelligence build on it in Phase 2.

Build budget

Workstream	Covers	Fixed fee
Sprint 0 — foundation (2 wks)	Masthead journey sign-off pack, insurer panel confirmation, POPIA essentials, architecture, Meta verification started	R60k
Web/PWA quote experience	Relaunched site, needs-analysis journey, installable PWA, case status, light brand refresh	R130k
WhatsApp channel	BSP setup & verification, journeys, document upload, advisor handover	R75k
Quote engine & insurer integrations	Launch panel of up to 5 short-term + 5 life insurers (Tier A/B where supported) + automated Tier C email workflow	R140k
Custom CRM, consent, security & tracking	Custom advisor workspace (v1 scope fixed in Sprint 0), FICA onboarding, document vault, POPIA consent, hardening, analytics	R150k
Lead ingestion & email automations	One bought-lead vendor feed into the CRM; automated follow-up and onboarding sequences	R40k
Launch Edition total · fixed price, ex VAT · 12 weeks		R595,000

Ongoing: hosting, support & maintenance

Item	Covers	Monthly
Hosting & licences	Cloud infrastructure, WhatsApp BSP licences, observability — no CRM licence fees (the CRM is owned)	included
Usage	WhatsApp messaging (customer-initiated service ≈ free under Meta’s 2025 pricing) and AI assistant usage	included
Support & maintenance	Fixes, insurer/API changes, journey optimisation and continuous improvement	included
Total ongoing — flat monthly fee, reviewed annually		R50k / month

Excluded: usage-based third-party fees passed through at cost (Meta conversation fees, document-AI processing, lead-vendor charges); own-FSP licensing costs if that path is chosen; performance-media budgets (GTM Wave 2 onward); insurer-specific certification costs where applicable.

How to read this investment

R595k buys the **proof**: real quotes on all three channels, live, inside a quarter. Phase 2 — native app, AI agent suite, full Customer 360 intelligence, analytics — is then scoped and priced on measured conversion and channel economics instead of projections. Every rand carries forward: the journeys, data model, vault and integrations built here are Phase 2’s foundation, not a throwaway pilot.

17 Business case & KPIs

The investment pays back through four compounding levers. Each has a measurable KPI tree the platform reports natively.

LEVER 1

Advice capacity

Automating intake, quoting and admin typically releases 40–60% of advisor time. Same advisor, several times the concurrent client journeys — capacity that currently caps revenue.

KPIs: needs analyses started/completed per month · quote cases per advisor-hour · time from enquiry to advice meeting.

LEVER 2

Conversion & speed

Quotes in minutes instead of days collapses drop-off between enquiry and comparison — the leakiest part of today's email funnel.

KPIs: enquiry → quote rate · quote → bind rate by insurer & segment · median time-to-first-quote (target: minutes for Tier A; <24h Tier B; SLA-met % Tier C).

LEVER 3

Retention & wallet share

Renewal intelligence and Customer 360 turn lapse-risk into pre-emptive conversations, and cover-gap analysis into structured cross-sell.

KPIs: policy lapse rate · renewals retained % · products per client · NBA actions taken/converted.

LEVER 4

New digital demand

WhatsApp + instant quotes open segments the practice could never economically serve by email — volume that compounds the book.

KPIs: new clients by channel · CAC by channel · WhatsApp journey completion % · portal/app monthly active clients.

Illustrative payback framing

A brokerage book earns recurring commission on premiums under advisement. If the Launch Edition enables the new practice to build **R300k–R500k in annual recurring commission** within 18 months of go-live — modest capture at the planned ±50 quotes/week from bought leads — the R595k investment recovers in roughly 14–24 months, while building a sellable, systematised asset: a platform-enabled book is worth a multiple of an inbox-dependent one. Sprint 0 replaces this framing with a model built on actual lead costs, conversion and commission rates.

Governance cadence

Monthly platform scorecard (KPIs above + TCF dashboard + cost-to-serve), quarterly strategy review against this document, and a post-launch investment gate before Phase 2 — so spend follows evidence, not momentum.

18 Risks & mitigations

Every material risk has an owner, a design answer and an early-warning signal. The top eight:

Risk	Rating	Mitigation
Regulatory breach via AI (advice boundary crossed)	High	Guardrail model (S9), BNI94 monitoring, advisor approval of client-facing templates, compliance pre-approval of journeys, full audit logging, periodic conversation sampling.
Licensing-structure delay (Masthead alignment / own FSP)	High	Sprint 0 workstream from week 1 with named compliance contact; both paths scoped; platform build decoupled so foundation work proceeds during resolution.
Insurer integration slower than planned	Medium–High	Three-tier model means launch never depends on any insurer; admin-platform route (Brolink/OWLS/Genasys) bundles many integrations; Tier C automation delivers value on day one.
POPIA incident / data breach	High impact	Security architecture (S12), minimisation to AI providers, operator agreements, pen tests, incident runbook with notification duties rehearsed.
Adoption shortfall (clients stay on email/phone)	Medium	WhatsApp meets clients in an app they already use daily; base-activation GTM; advisor personally introduces the channel; email/phone remain supported — the platform captures them as cases either way.
Scope creep / budget overrun	Medium	Fixed-scope phases with investment gates; Sprint 0 converts envelopes to committed SOWs; monthly burn vs. scorecard.
Key-person dependency (solo advisor)	Medium	The platform itself is the mitigation: codified journeys, Customer 360 and case management make the practice resilient and scalable beyond one inbox; consider a paraplanner/assistant as volume grows.
Vendor lock-in (admin platform, BSP, AI provider)	Low–Medium	Interface-first architecture (S13): every external dependency behind an adapter; data exportable; LLM-agnostic AI gateway.

19 Recommended next steps

Momentum matters more than perfection. Five concrete steps start the journey within two weeks:

STEP 1 Strategy workshop Week 1	Half-day session: walk this document with Marlin Moodley, confirm the Launch Edition scope, segment priorities and the licensing question's importance.
STEP 2 Engage Masthead Weeks 1–2	Joint session with the licence holder's compliance function on digital journeys, AI guardrails and record-keeping — establishing the partnership (or surfacing the own-FSP conversation) before a line of code is written.
STEP 3 Ship the quick wins Week 2	Fix the contact leaks, publish compliance pages, add WhatsApp click-to-chat, sharpen the homepage message. Small cost, immediate lead recovery, visible momentum for the client.
STEP 4 Commission Sprint 0 Week 2	Accept Quotation № MM-2026-01: R60,000 starts Sprint 0, credited in full against the R595,000 fixed price. Covers licensing alignment, insurer launch-panel confirmation, POPIA essentials, and the 12-week build plan.
STEP 5 Secure early integrations Weeks 2–8	Open conversations with the priority insurers on the launch panel and the WhatsApp BSP in parallel — commercial lead times, not engineering, usually set the critical path.

The closing argument

The South African insurance gap is R50.4 trillion and widening. Customers already live in the channels this platform serves. The APIs exist. The regulation is navigable — and favours whoever builds compliance in from the start. Marlin Moodley's trusted-advice brand is the hardest asset to replicate; everything in this document is engineering around it. The practices that move from "email and wait" to "orchestrate and advise" in the next 24 months will own the intermediary space in their segments. We recommend starting now.